

The Toyota Yaris has a whole lot of features to wow the new-age car buyers, but are they enough to overlap the few shortcomings that remain with the car?

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The Toyota Yaris launched amidst much fanfare. What really worked for the Yaris pre-launch is its reputation as a reliable, spacious and feature-rich sedan that sells pretty well in global markets.

When it comes to India, however, many companies often struggle to match the levels of quality and refinement in cars that sell heavily in more mature markets. In India, the foremost questions while buying a car revolve around its value proposition, fuel efficiency, ease of servicing and how much more can it provide against its competition, for around the same amount of money. Does the Toyota Yaris manage to do all of this?

THE IMMEDIATE COMPETITION

The Yaris enters the market with a whole set of interesting new features - seven airbags as standard, gesture controls (albeit gimmicky than functional) for the infotainment system, roof-mounted air conditioning vents, and so on. Alongside, it presents manual and automatic gearboxes across all its variants, thereby offering one of the least expensive automatic sedans that you can buy in India (barring the AMT options). For a thorough analysis of all its variants, click here. For further reading on exactly how it fares in face of its prime competitors, read more here.

INFOTAINMENT SYSTEM AND MID

Alongside the usual array of input interfaces on the 7-inch touchscreen infotainment system, you also get WeLink, Miracast and an HDMI

port as standard across the three top variants, and the VX variant we drove also had gesture-based media control, integrated navigation, an SD card slot and Wi-Fi hotspot support. There is also a CD drive, which is revealed by flipping up the entire display panel.

The display is not of the highest resolution, so icons and other visuals don't look very sharp. The rather colourful interface is bright, and with its smartphone-like layout with large, chunky icons, is easy to oper-

ate. It is not the most subtle in terms of design, but it does score high in terms of discoverability of features, ergonomics and ease of usage. The home screen includes a day-date-time readout alongside four icons that can be arranged as per convenience, and a five-icon shortcut bar complete with an app drawer, almost exactly like smartphone interfaces of today. Once you synchronise the infotainment system with your smartphone, you can also load a list of third-party apps to the system to further customise



TOYOTA YARIS REVIEW: A WHOLE LOTTA NEW

